

Q. Explain how Belgium accommodated the diversity? ⑤

accepted equal representation in the Central Government.

Dutch C.G.



Apart from the Central and the State Government, there is a third kind of government. This community government is elected by people belonging to one language community – Dutch, French and German-speaking – no matter where they live. This government has the power regarding cultural, educational and language-related issues.

You might find the Belgian model very complicated. It indeed is very complicated, even for people living in Belgium. But these arrangements have worked well so far. They helped to avoid civic strife between the two major communities and a possible division of the country on linguistic lines. When many countries of



European Parliament in Brussels, Belgium

Europe came together to form the European Union. Brussels was chosen as its headquarters.

So you are saying that sharing of power makes us more powerful. Sounds odd! Let me think.



Read any newspaper for one week and make clippings of news related to ongoing conflicts or wars. A group of five students could pool their clippings together and do the following:

- Classify these conflicts by their location (your state, India, outside India).
- Find out the cause of each of these conflicts. How many of these are related to power sharing disputes?
- Which of these conflicts could be resolved by working out power sharing arrangements?

What do we learn from these two stories of Belgium and Sri Lanka? Both are democracies. Yet, they dealt with the question of power sharing differently. In Belgium, the leaders have realised that the unity of the country is possible only by respecting the feelings and interests of different communities

and regions. Such a realisation resulted in mutually acceptable arrangements for sharing power. Sri Lanka shows us a contrasting example. It shows us that if a majority community wants to force its dominance over others and refuses to share power, it can undermine the unity of the country.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2025 - Set [32/6/1]

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): There was civil war in Sri Lanka.

Reason (R): An Act was passed in 1956 to secure dominance of Sinhala community on the government.

Options :

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (C) (A) is correct, but (R) is incorrect.
- (D) (A) is incorrect, but (R) is correct.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/2/2]

In Sri Lanka, which one of the following changes to the 1956 law gave rise to the possibility of civil war?

(A) Ensuring power sharing among all sections.

(B) Declaring Sinhala as the ^{only} official language.

(C) Declaring Tamil as the official language.

(D) Implementing a policy of preference for Sinhalese in government jobs.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2025 - Set [32/2/1]

Which one of the following organisations has its headquarter in Brussels?

- (A) United Nations Organisation
- ☒ (B) European Union
- (C) Non-Alignment Movement
- (D) South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation

Belgium took some measures to solve its problem. Read the following measures and choose the correct option :

I. Formation of community government.

II. Following majoritarian policy. ✗

III. By providing equal representation of language groups.

IV. By providing additional powers to local governments. ?

Options:

(A) Only I, II and III are correct. ✗

(B) Only I, III and IV are correct.

(C) Only I, II and IV are correct. ✗

(D) Only II, III and IV are correct. ✓

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2024 - Set [32/3/3]

Identify the primary objective of power sharing arrangements in Belgium from the following options.

- (A) Establishing a unitary form of government.
- (B) Centralized political control of government.
- (C) Establishing cultural and educational matters of Dutch.
- ~~(D) Accommodating linguistic and regional interest.~~

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/5/2]

Two statements are given below. They are Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option:

Assertion (A): Belgium's power sharing arrangements were designed to accommodate its linguistic and cultural divisions.

Reason (R): Belgian leaders recognized the existence of regional differences and cultural diversities.

Option:

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2025 - Set [32/2/1]

"The government measures gradually increased the feeling of alienation among the Sri Lankan Tamils." Explain the statement.

↓
Homework Question

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2025 - Set [32/6/1]

“The law enacted in 1956 and other Constitutional Provisions led to major conflict between the two communities in Sri Lanka.” Support the statement.

Same as previous

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2019 - Set [32/3/1]

How did the feeling of alienation develop among the Sri Lankan Tamils?

Same.

[Sawal Behumpiya hota hai]

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 32/5/1 (2020)

Describe the elements of Belgian model for accommodating diversities. 3

Today's homework Question

- Equal French and dutch.
- Capital
- State
- Community.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/2/2]

Compare the Belgian model and the Sri Lankan model of power sharing. 5

↓	
<u>Accommodation</u>	<u>Majoritarianism</u>

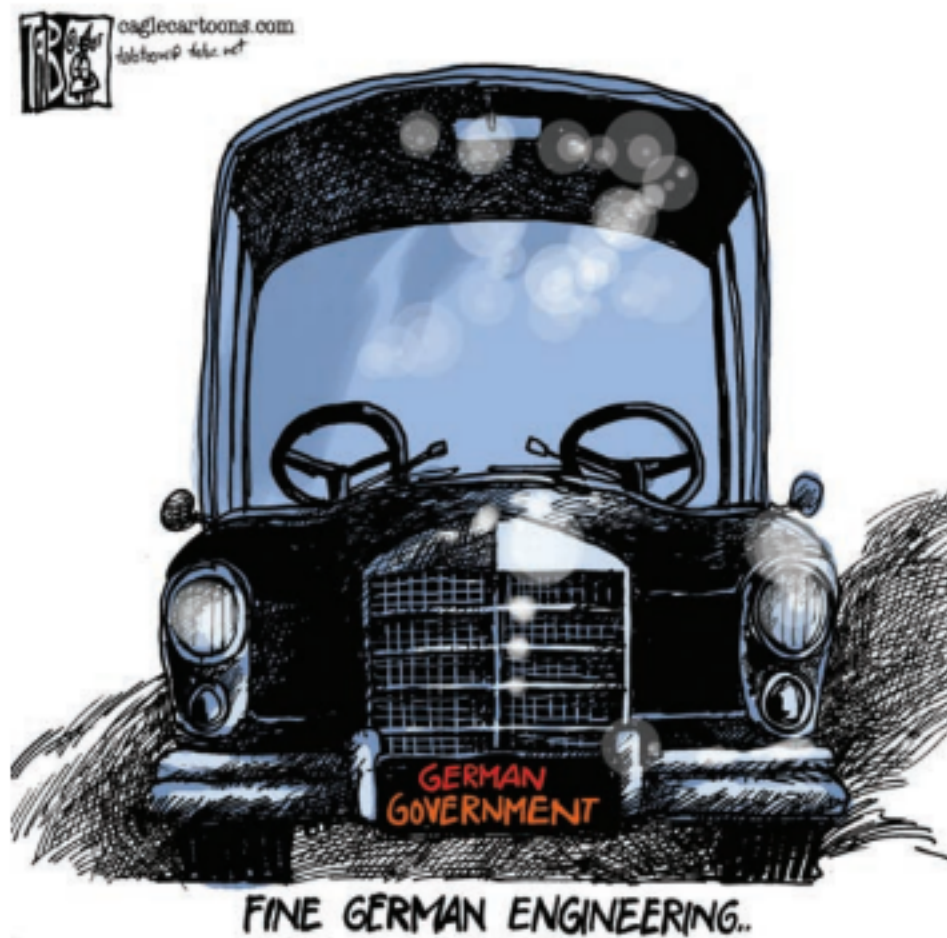
Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2019 - Set [32/3/1]

How is community government elected in Belgium?

3

↓
People belongin one language.



© Tab - The Calgary Sun, Eagle Cartoons Inc.

The cartoon at the left refers to the problems of running Germany's grand coalition government that includes the two major parties of the country, namely the Christian Democratic Union and the Social Democratic Party. The two parties are historically rivals to each other. They had to form a coalition government because neither of them got clear majority of seats on their own in the 2005 elections. They take divergent positions on several policy matters, but still jointly run the government.

For details about the German Parliament, visit <https://www.bundestag.de/en>

Tyranny of the majority is not just oppressive for the minority; it often affects majority adversely as well.

There is a second, deeper reason why power sharing is good for democracies. Power sharing is the very spirit of democracy. A democratic rule involves sharing power with those affected by its exercise, and who have to live with its effects. People have a right to be consulted on how they are to be governed. A legitimate government is one where citizens, through participation, acquire a stake in the system.

Let us call the first set of reasons PRUDENTIAL and the second moral. While prudential reasons stress that power sharing will bring out better outcomes, moral reasons emphasise the very act of power sharing as valuable.

Ques Why power sharing is desirable?

Thus, two different sets of reasons can be given in favour of power sharing. Firstly, power sharing is good because it helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups. Since social conflict often leads to violence and political instability, power sharing is a good way to ensure the stability of political order. Imposing the will of majority community over others may look like an attractive option in the short run, but in the long run it undermines the unity of the nation.

Glossary

Prudential: Based on prudence, or on careful calculation of gains and losses. Prudential decisions are usually contrasted with decisions based purely on moral considerations.

Annette studies in a Dutch medium school in the northern region of Belgium. Many French-speaking students in her school want the medium of instruction to be French. Selvi studies in a school in the northern region of Sri Lanka. All the students in her school are Tamil-speaking and they want the medium of instruction to be Tamil.

- If the parents of Annette and Selvi were to approach respective governments to realise the desire of the child who is more likely to succeed? And why?